

SAS Roadmap

Plattform Netzwerktreffen

Heino Rust unter Verwendung von Material von
Cheryl Doninger Distinguished Technical Advocate, SAS R&D



50 years of defining what's next



Fifty years ago, SAS began as a statistical language in academia. Today, we help power trusted decisions around the world, in every industry.

We've evolved with every economic shift and technology transition, but our focus has never changed: innovate with integrity. Put customers first. Deliver decisions you can trust.

The next 50? We're just getting started.



The Power to Know[®]
for 50 Years

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Information regarding potential future development work is not a commitment or obligation to deliver any code or functionality, and in no way represents contractual obligation by SAS.

Agenda

- Standard Support Overview

- Wichtigste Änderungen

Ausgeblendet zum späteren Nachlesen im Anhang:

- SAS 9.4
- SAS Viya 3.5
- SAS Viya (on Kubernetes)

- SAS Viya

- Architecture changes
- Data Management Portfolio
- Visual Analytics

Wichtigste Änderungen zum SAS Support

Alle Plattformen

SAS 9.4

- Aktuell Standard Support für M8 (bis Anfang 2028) und M9 (bis Mitte 2030)
- M10 erscheint voraussichtlich im ersten Halbjahr 2027

SAS Viya 3.5

- Supportende Oktober 2027 – jetzt agieren
- SAS Account Team, SAS Professional Services und/oder SAS Partner kontaktieren, um die Umstellung auf SAS Viya vorzubereiten.

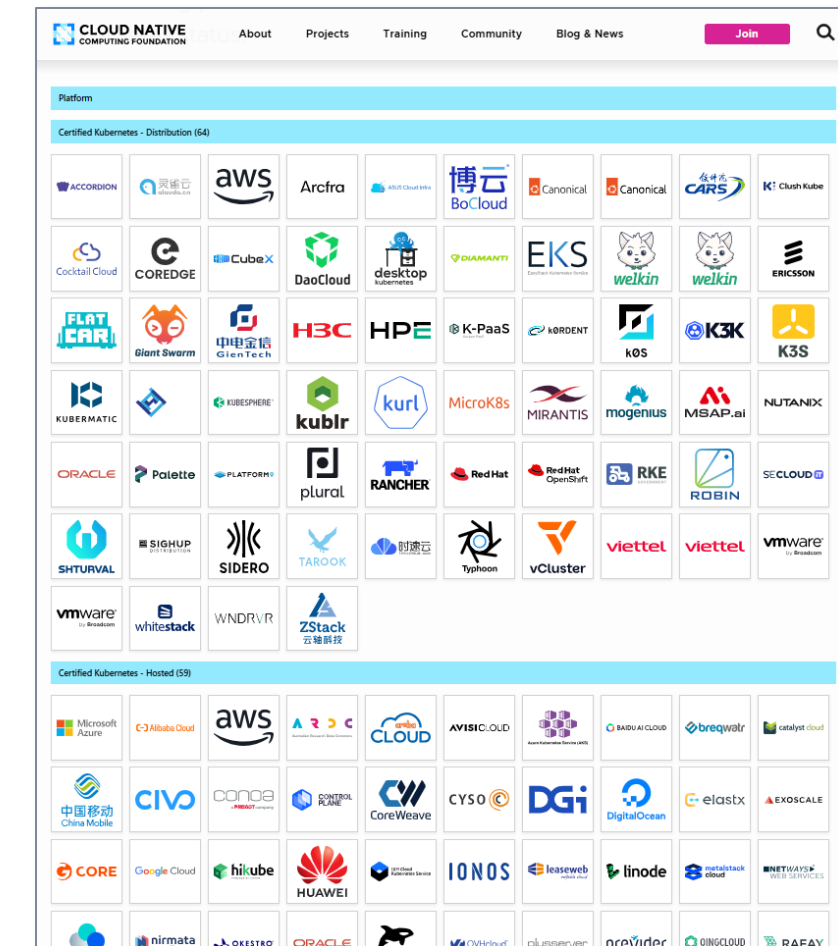
SAS Viya on Kubernetes

- Support für CNCF-Kubernetes
- Erweiterte Kooperationsmöglichkeiten mit europäischen Cloud-Anbietern
 - OVH ist auf der SIOT vertreten

Updated Support Policy for SAS Viya

Extending standard support for all CNCF-distributed Kubernetes platforms

- **Extended Kubernetes Support (SAS Viya – May 2026 release)**
 - Responding to strong customer demand to align with enterprise IT strategies and regulatory requirements
 - Since May 2026: [CNCF-certified Kubernetes platforms](#) qualify for Standard Support (subject to platform requirements)
 - Unlocks deployment across [60+ Kubernetes platforms](#) with full support
- **Coverage now includes:**
 - Global cloud providers ([IBM Cloud](#), [Oracle Cloud](#), ...)
 - European cloud providers with focus on digital sovereignty ([StackIT](#), [OVHcloud](#), ...)
 - Leading Kubernetes distributions ([Rancher](#), [Tanzu](#), ...)
- **Previously:**
 - Full support limited to a small set of validated Kubernetes platforms
 - Other platforms only covered with restricted technical support



The **Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF)** defines a conformance program for Kubernetes.

Vendors/products labeled “CNCF-certified Kubernetes” pass standardized tests ensuring API compatibility and interoperability.

<https://www.cncf.io/training/certification/software-conformance/>

Architectural Changes Next 3 Years

Concepts, Vision and Strategy

Architektonische Änderungen 2025/2026

SAS Viya Workload Management
aktiv per Default

SAS Compute Task auf Viya

SAS Access Schnittstelle zu
DuckDB

Ingress NGINX – Ende des
Supports => Contour

=> Umstellung auf
Gateway API

Audit Service Model Change

Need Your Feedback



Traditional audit entries (visible through the "sas-viya audit list" CLI command) will no longer be recorded by default



Moving from low-level (and verbose) audit records for every service request to a higher-level user activities

Pro - reduce number of audit entries persisted to database

Con - will impact troubleshooting and tracking of security related events



Examples no longer recorded

every time a user hits a 403 error because they didn't have access to a particular resource

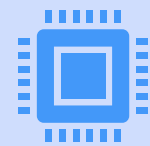
all 500 level errors that may have been thrown from some low-level request



Will this impact your auditing abilities???

Zero Downtime Rolling Updates (ZDRU)

Continuity of Business



All Viya servers, services and Solutions will support zero downtime rolling updates

End users do not experience an outage during the upgrade or when applying patches



Pre-deploy or post-deployment steps during upgrade may exist as long as these steps do not require an outage and affect the running system

Automation will be provided where possible



oldest supported stable release under standard support to a supported future cadence release

Unless Kubernetes update is required



Ongoing in 2026, no delivery date defined

CAS Scaling

Continuing to address TCO into 2026

On-going development currently behind a feature flag

CAS spin down

Listen to CAS sessions to determine period of quietness and spin CAS down

Spins down entire CAS server

There is a UI component for an authorized user to scale the CAS server back up

Currently implemented for Risk, other applications to be added in the future

CAS hibernate/suspend

CAS blue/green background balancing of tables

Will hibernate but save tables and reload when CAS comes back

Crunchy Postgres for Kubernetes

End of Support

Final release of Crunchy Postgres for Kubernetes (CPK) on December 31, 2026

This is the Internal PostgreSQL used by SAS Viya by default

SAS will implement a fully integrated replacement for CPK capability within the SAS Viya platform

- Provided prior to December 31, 2026
- Transition to be transparent

SAS already supports the use of an external PostgreSQL database

Future updates posted to Customer Success and SAS Communities.

Consul Removal & Secrets Management

Addressing TCO | In Research, No Delivery Date Defined

Consul Removal

- 3-node cluster being retired; functionality now covered by K8S services
- Reduces resource consumption and platform footprint
- Changes how configuration properties and settings are persisted

Secrets Management

- Credentials migrating out of Consul to internal Vault deployment
- Future integration with external secret providers across major cloud vendors

Secure Compute Libraries

- The problem
 - Viya parity to SAS 9 user access to data libraries
 - Need to secure Viya SAS **library access based on the session client identity**
 - **P**rovide identity-based access controls to predefined libraries and filesystem paths
- The solution
 - Ability to define/change which users or groups can see/use a connection as defined in C3
 - Similar to how CASLIBs and CDE work
 - Library level only (not table, row, column)

SAS Batch Runtime (SBR) – Early Preview /experimental

What is it?

Licensed, customizable SAS
Viya container

SAS Programming Runtime
Environment image

No SAS Viya dependencies once
built, decoupled from Viya

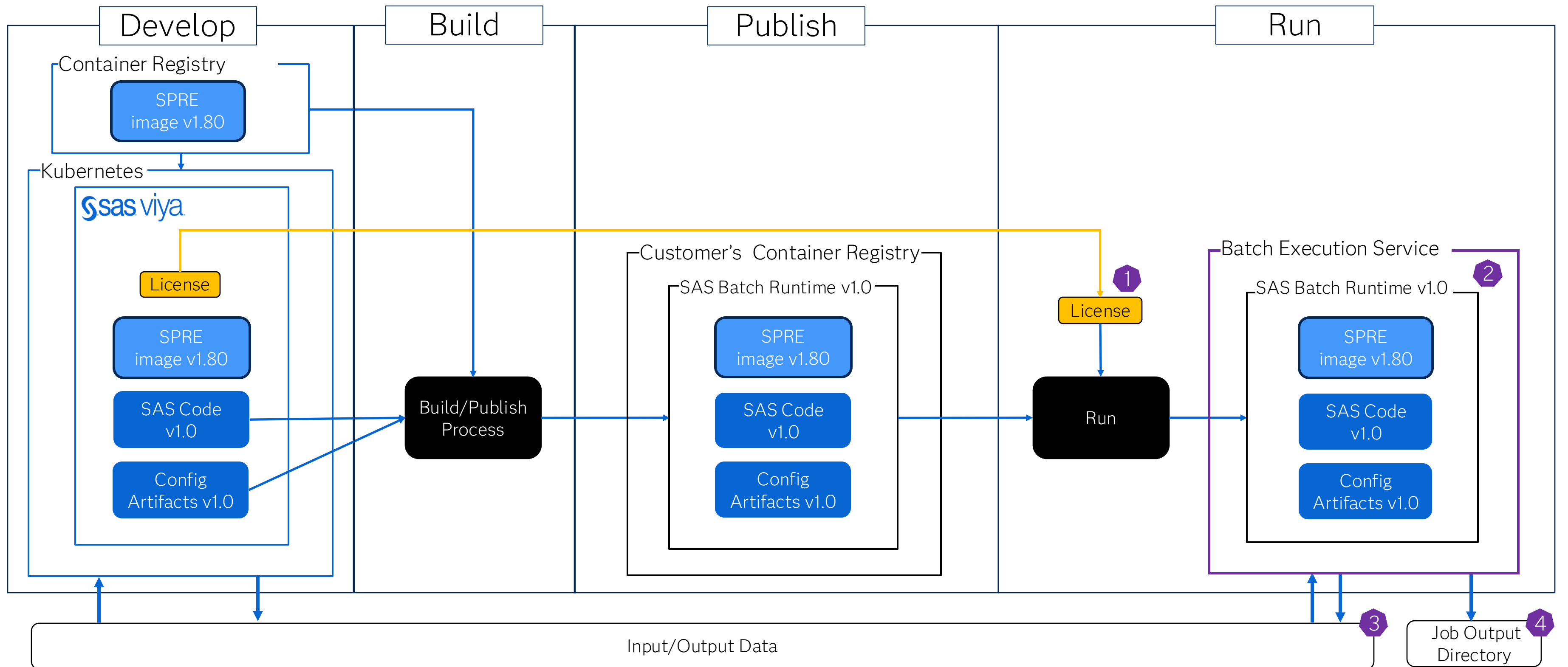
Runs with any cloud-based
execution service

- Docker, AWS batch, Azure Batch, Google Cloud Batch, Kubernetes
- Anything that can run a container

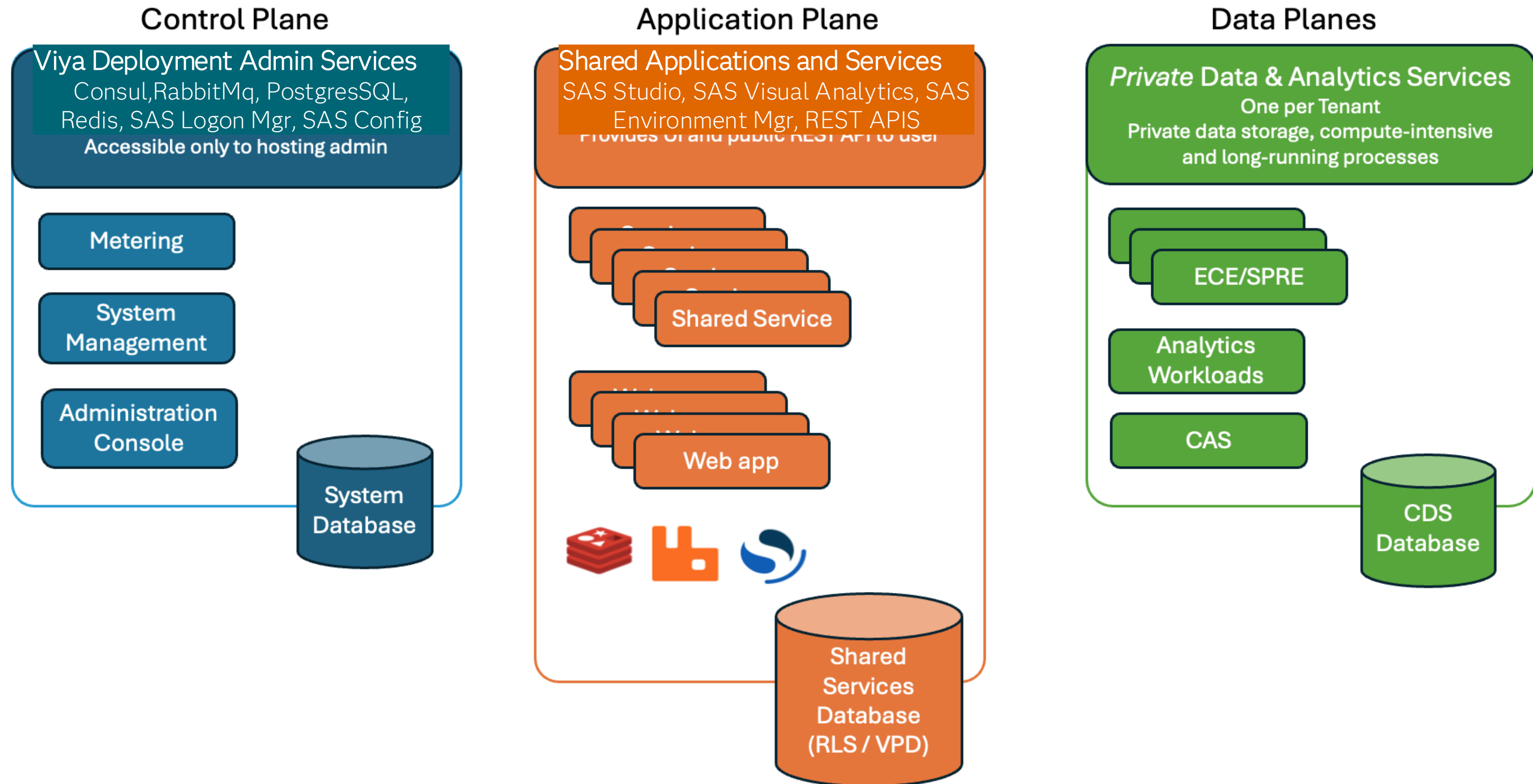
Minimal changes to existing SAS
Code

- Additional configuration

Build & Runtime Workflow



Viya Architecture Evolution – Split Plane



Data Management Portfolio

Data Management Portfolio – Relaunch 2026.06

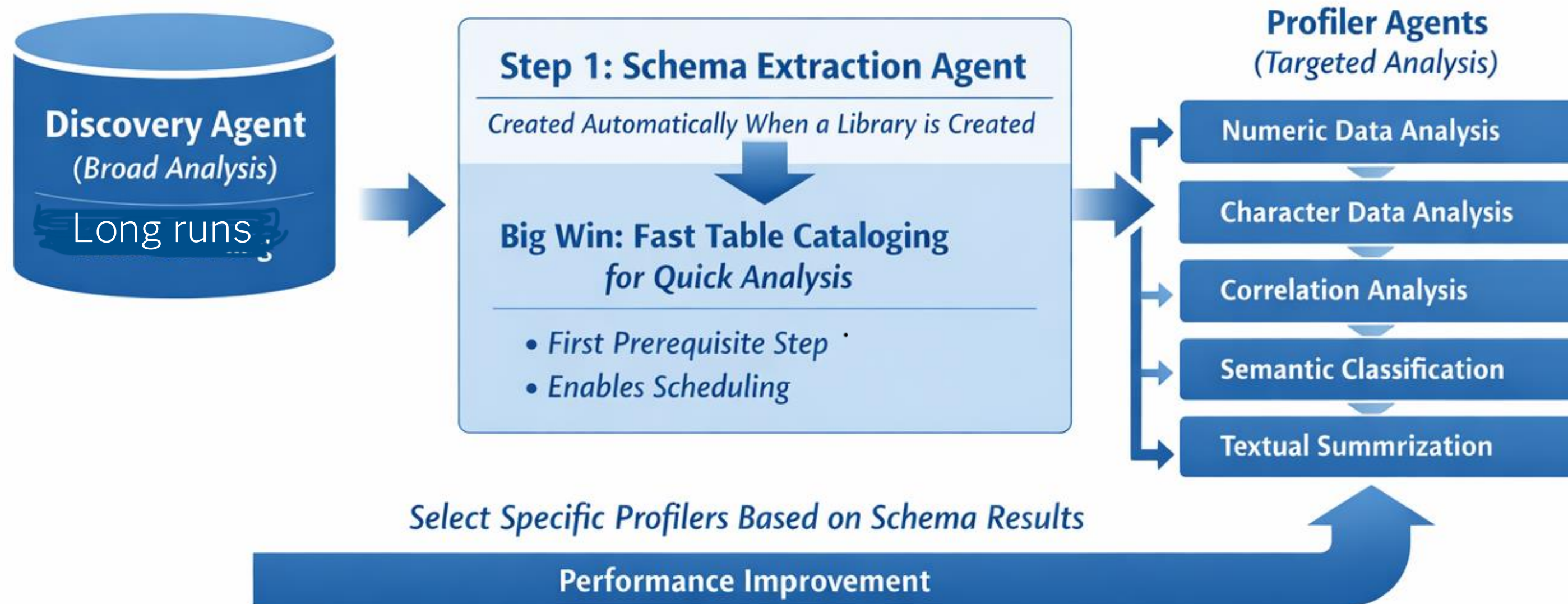
Agentic AI workflow capabilities now built directly into Data Management platform

Access/Acceleration <i>Access</i>	Engineering <i>Prepare</i>	Data Quality & Governance <i>Govern</i>
Web Apps		
SAS Data Hub Seamlessly connect and onboard data	SAS Data & AI Studio Make data high-quality, trusted and reliable	SAS Data Governance Trust, manage and govern data & AI
Addons		
SAS Data Hub Adv. SAS Data Hub Ent.	SAS Data & AI Studio Adv. SAS Data & AI Studio Ent.	SAS Data Governance Adv. SAS Data Governance Ent. SAS Address Verification
SAS Data Accelerator		
Technology Offerings		
SAS SpeedyStore	SAS Data Engineering - SAS Data Engineering Adv. – SAS Data Engineering Ent.*	

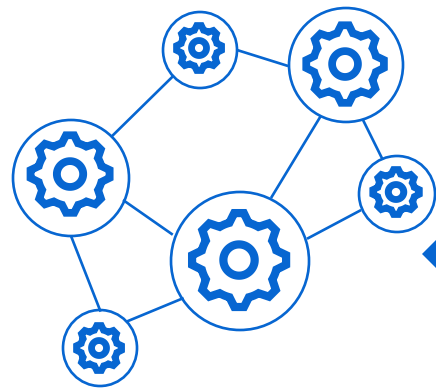
SAS Data Governance - Profilers

Monolithic discovery agent

Modular Profiler agent



Phase 1 (2026.04) – Rules for Data Quality



SAS Provided – Phase 1

- Rule Templates
- Rule Definitions (REST API only)
- Rule Definition Execution (Studio React-based step)
- Public REST API for all operations

User responsibility – Phase 1

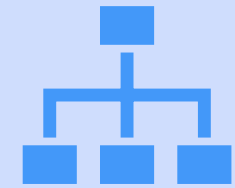
- Append to results history table
- Dashboards
- Alerting
- Post-processing to initiate workflows for remediation



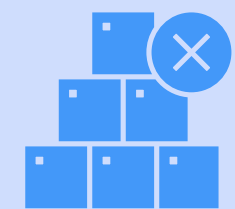
Roadmap for next 9-12 months



Rule Management UI inside SAS Information Catalog
- Create and Edit Rule Definitions



Rule Templates for Data Schema



Rule Definitions using AND/OR/NOT to combine multiple Templates and Definitions

SAS Studio

Enhancements

Enhanced file and folder selector

- shipped 2026.01
- Resolved a number of defects including the ability to create a new folder in SAS server

Ability to display generated code for a single step in a flow

- In development

R programming support

- shipping 2026.04

Continued addition of new steps

Lineage/Impact Analysis

Embedded application switching

- Eliminate need to go to navigation pane

SAS Visual Analytics

2026 Outlook

SAS Visual Analytics

Projects and Research for 2026

Continued Gen AI work (Copilot)

Lower TCO, focused on CAS

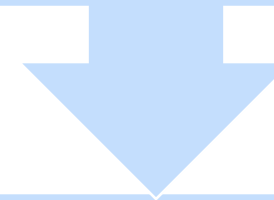
Improvements to VA Publish

Continued work on SAS Graph Builder integration

SAS Visual Analytics

Lower TCO, focused on CAS

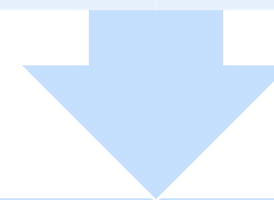
SAS SpeedyStore introduced in 2025



CAS scalability – **research**

Grow and shrink

CAS optional



SAS Visual Analytics direct to database – **research**

Generate SQL to pass
directly to database

Pure data management
use cases

Will never have analytics
provided by CAS

Eliminate the need of in-
memory server

SAS Visual Analytics

Improvements to VA Publish & Graph Builder Integration

Improvements to VA Publish

Solution to public reporting using a run-time container

Completely divorced from SAS Viya

Graph Builder Integration

Support for more objects

Eventual full parity of SAS Graph Builder functionality



Architectural Changes Appendix

Architektonische Änderungen 2025/2026

Bereits gelieferte Komponenten und End-of-support für Ingress NGINX

SAS Viya Workload Management

- SAS Workload Orchestrator (SWO) verwaltet alle Jobs, Ressourcen und Lastverteilung über Warteschlangen und Prioritäten
- Erweitert die Workload-Management-Funktionen von Kubernetes
- Kein Enterprise-Scheduling enthalten – Apache Airflow oder andere Scheduler empfohlen (über Viya Batch CLI)

SAS Compute Task auf Viya

- Compute Tasks seit 2025.09 für kurze SAS-Code-Ausführungen (ähnlich STP-Verarbeitung)
- Synchroner Aufruf mit Ein-/Verarbeitung/Ausgabe in einem Schritt (multipart/form-data)
- Parameter ähnlich wie bei Job-Definitionen (wie STP, für SASJobExecution Service)
- Wiederverwendbare Compute-Server laufen als vordefinierter Benutzer (für Geschwindigkeit)

SAS/Access-Schnittstelle zu DuckDB

- Open-Source In-Process-Engine, versteht offene Formate
- Vektorisierte, optimierte Abfrageausführung auf spaltenbasiertem Speicher
- Keine Serverinstallation oder externe Abhängigkeiten erforderlich
- In SAS Viya ab Release 2025.07 enthalten
- Breite Unterstützung für offene Datei- und Tabellenformate
- Umfangreiche Komprimierung spart Speicherkosten (mit Kompromissen)

Ingress NGINX – Ende des Supports

- Im März 2026 eingestellt – keine neuen Bugfixes oder Sicherheitspatches
- Contour als strategischer Ersatz ausgewählt (sofortiger Wechsel möglich, kein Viya-Update nötig)
- NGINX-Unterstützung bis mindestens Stable/LTS 2027.03
- Langfristige Strategie: Umstieg von Ingress auf die Gateway API